

FORM TP 2018009



TEST CODE **01219010**

JANUARY 2018

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

**CARIBBEAN SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE®
EXAMINATION**

ENGLISH B

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

1 hour 45 minutes

READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS CAREFULLY.

1. This paper consists of THREE questions. Answer ALL questions.
2. Write your answers in the spaces provided in this answer booklet.
3. Do NOT write in the margins.
4. You are advised to take some time to read through the paper and plan your answers.
5. If you need to rewrite any answer and there is not enough space to do so on the original page, you must use the extra lined page(s) provided at the back of this booklet. **Remember to draw a line through your original answer.**
6. **If you use the extra page(s) you MUST write the question number clearly in the box provided at the top of the extra page(s) and, where relevant, include the question part beside the answer.**

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

Copyright © 2017 Caribbean Examinations Council
All rights reserved.

01219010/JANUARY 2018



0121901003



SECTION A – DRAMA

1. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

PHYLLIS)

MERLE) *Goodnight, Mums.*

(Phyllis sees her to the door, then turns and speaks to Merle).

PHYLLIS: Hadn't we better go and put on our dresses, Merle? Henry should be here soon.

MERLE: There's no hurry. It's always a good thing to keep them waiting a little.

- 5 PHYLLIS: *(sits in rocker)* When are you two going to get hitched?

MERLE: Mind your own business. *(She is still in a temper. Phyllis goes back quietly to her reading on the couch and, after a moment, Merle is apologetic).* Sorry, Snooty, you know I don't mean that.

PHYLLIS: It's all right, Merle, I understand.

- 10 MERLE: Well, the truth is I told Henry I'd give him a definite answer this week. And I was hoping Jim would have kept his new job. But he had to go and walk out on this one too. I'm damned if I should saddle my affairs with his any more, Phyllis. I don't care what happens to Jim, I'm going to tell Henry to fix a date as soon as he likes.

- 15 PHYLLIS: *(after a pause)* Merle, when you get married and move into your new house, you think Mother and me can keep this one going?

MERLE: That's just the point. If Jim was getting a good salary I think you three could live very nicely together. But so long as he is out of work – carrying on as if he had a rich godfather somewhere – I don't see how you one can keep the house going.

- 20 PHYLLIS: But what to do?

MERLE: One good thing is, Mother is such a dear she won't be any trouble. Her small pension can buy any little thing she needs. But how, in the name of heaven, I can ask Henry to support a strapping young man like Jim ...

- 25 PHYLLIS: And yet if we move in with you and leave Jim on his own it would break Mother's heart.

- MERLE: You all can do what you like. But so long as Jim believes he's a Dickens or a John Keats', for my part he can damn well live like one. Keats, huh! *(She goes to Jim's desk, extracts a few sheets of paper and looks at one of his recent short poems.)* The thing's all damn nonsense. You can't understand a line of it. Listen to this one.
- 30

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



(She reads it very scornfully. As she finishes the first verse Jim enters at the front door. He turns livid at Merle's mockery.)

JIM: *(snarling)* Drop it!

MERLE: The Poet Laureate² of Trinidad!

35 JIM: *(dangerously)* Drop it, I say! *(He rushes at Merle who backs away, dropping the sheets, Phyllis interposes.)*

PHYLLIS: Jim, please don't start any ...

JIM: *(pushing her aside, to Merle)* Why the hell you don't mind your own business? What right you have going in my desk? You can't leave me alone?

40 MERLE: Yes, as soon as you leave the rest of us alone and stop sponging on us. A big man like you going round idle these days, giving up jobs as if you were a millionaire.

JIM: I'll do something when I'm good and ready. Nobody's begging you for anything. Go and get married as soon as you like. And I hope you raise a bunch of square pegs like me.

45 PHYLLIS: *(quickly)* Jim, please don't talk like that.

JIM: All you can see is your own petty desires. Other people's suffering don't bother you. Go on, get married, and I hope you get half the things you expect out of it.

PHYLLIS: Jim, please, you're not being fair. After all, you have most to be thankful for. You were able to finish school while Merle and me ...

50 JIM: And you think, I'm grateful for that. Is it my fault? I tell you the whole world's cockeyed. I wish to heaven there'd be another war to wipe us all out.

MERLE: Well wipe yourself out first and leave us in peace.

JIM: Yes, fling it in my face. You supporting me. A big kick I get out of that. The sooner I get the hell out of this country the better.

Adapted from Errol Hill, "Square Peg". In Caribbean Plays: One Act Play XXVI, UWI Extra-Mural Department, 1996, pp. 8–11.

¹ Charles Dickens was a famous writer and John Keats a famous poet.

² An outstanding poet officially appointed by a government. The highest honor a poet or writer can aspire to achieve.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (a) Outline the MAIN issue in lines 1–14.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)

- (b) What TWO things does the audience learn about Jim? Support your answer with evidence from the extract.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(4 marks)

- (c) Using evidence from the extract, explain the role of Phyllis.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)



- (d) Comment on the dramatic significance of the mother.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)

- (e) Explain ONE way in which the playwright uses stage directions to create tension in the extract.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)

- (f) Comment on Merle's use of sarcasm in the lines 26–27, "But so long as Jim believes he's a Dickens or a John Keats, for my part he can damn well live like one".

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (g) Suggest a title for the extract. Use evidence from the extract to justify your choice.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)

Total 20 marks



NOTHING HAS BEEN OMITTED.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

01219010/JANUARY 2018



0121901009



SECTION B – POETRY

2. Read the following poem carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Then and Now

- Back then when he was still
In the morning of his life
He used to fly to the hospital
To donate his blood singing with life
5 As soon as the hospital issued
The annual call for volunteers.
Always, they'd smile and thank him
In the typical polite Canadian manner
And give him a glass of orange juice.
10 But long before he reached the pavement
A grim-faced technician would
Quickly label it Black.
Later, she'd flush it down the toilet.
- One day when he was still young
15 He jumped to his feet
To give a feathery old lady
His seat on a crowded bus.
But she stared at him blankly,
Trying unsuccessfully to suppress
20 Her raging hatred, so overpowering
That he could clearly read
The curses being printed
Like a raised tattoo across her forehead.
- Now that he is older, wiser and saner,
25 He hoards every drop of his black blood,
He glues himself to his seat,
And he sits on the bus unseeingly
As feathery old ladies slam
From side to side on the crowded bus
30 Under the weight of their ages and parcels
And the cool fire in his eyes,
Reflecting a fiercer fire within,
Would sear the eyeballs of all those
Who would dare question his manner.

*Winston Franco, "Then and Now". In Other Voices: Writings by Blacks
in Canada, William Wallace Publishers Inc.,
1985, pp. 78–79.*

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE

- (a) Describe what is happening in stanza 1.

.....

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)

- (b) What is the speaker's attitude to the man? Use evidence from the poem to support your answer.

.....

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)

- (c) What impression of the "feathery old lady" is created in lines 18–23? Use evidence from the poem to support your answer.

.....

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



(d) Identify the figurative device in ONE of the following and comment on its effectiveness:

- “The curses being printed / Like a raised tattoo across her forehead” (lines 22–23)
- “the cool fire in his eyes” (line 31)

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)

(e) Identify ONE example of contrast in the poem and show how it highlights the major theme in the poem.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)



- (f) (i) Comment on the effectiveness of lines 33–34, “Would sear the eyeballs of all those / Who would dare question his manner”.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)

- (ii) Comment on the poet’s use of repetition in the poem.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)

- (g) Suggest another title for the poem. Justify your response with evidence from the poem.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)

Total 20 marks

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



SECTION C – PROSE FICTION

3. Read the following passage carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

Summer came. A summer limp with the weight of blossomed things. Heavy sunflowers weeping over fences; iris curling and browning at the edges far away from their purple hearts; ears of corn letting their auburn hair wind down their stalks. And the boys. The beautiful, beautiful boys who dotted the landscape like jewels and thickened the river with their shining wet backs.

- 5 In that mercury mood in July, Sula and Nel wandered about the Bottom barefoot, looking for mischief. They decided to go down by the river where the boys sometimes swam. Nel waited on the porch while Sula ran into the house to go to the toilet. On the way up the stairs, she passed the kitchen where Hannah sat with two friends, Patsy and Valentine. The two women were watching Hannah put down some dough, all talking casually, and had gotten around, when Sula passed by,
10 to the problems of child rearing.

“They a pain.”

“Oh, I don’t know. My Rudy minds his daddy. He just wild with me. Be glad when he growed and gone.”

Hannah smiled and said, “Shut your mouth. You love the ground he pee on.”

- 15 “Sure I do. But he still a pain. Can’t help loving your own child. No matter what they do.”

“Well, Hester grown now and I can’t say love is exactly what I feel.”

“Sure you do. You love her, like I love Sula. I just don’t like her. That’s the difference.”

“Guess so. Likin’ them is another thing.”

- 20 She only heard Hannah’s words, and the pronouncement sent her flying up the stairs. In bewilderment, she stood at the window, aware of a sting in her eye. Nel’s call floated up and into the window, pulling her away from dark thoughts back into the bright, hot daylight.

- 25 They ran most of the way. Heading towards the wide part of the river where trees grouped themselves in families darkening the earth below. They ran in the sunlight, then gazed out over the swift dull water as an unspeakable restlessness and agitation held them. At the same instant each girl heard footsteps in the grass. A little boy in too big knickers was coming up from the lower bank of the river. He stopped when he saw them.

“Come on, Chicken. Look, I’ll help you climb a tree.”

- 30 Chicken looked at the tree Sula was pointing to. He moved slowly towards her. Sula took him by the hand and coaxed him along. When they were as high as they could go, Sula stopped and together they slowly worked their way down.

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



Chicken was still elated. “I was way up there, wasn’t I? Wasn’t I? I’m a tell my brovver.” Sula and Nel began to mimic him: “I’m a tell my brovver; I’m a tell my brovver.”

35 Sula picked him up by his hands and swung him outward then around and around. His knickers ballooned and his shrieks of frightened joy startled the birds and the fat grasshoppers. When he slipped from her hands and sailed away out over the water they could still hear his bubbly laughter.

Adapted from Toni Morrison, Sula, Plume Books, 1973, pp. 56–61.

(a) (i) Where is this story set?

.....

 (1 mark)

(ii) Identify ONE use of repetition in paragraph 1 and suggest ONE purpose of its use.

.....

 (2 marks)

(b) Identify the figurative device used in the following extract and comment on its effectiveness:

“beautiful boys who dotted the landscape like jewels” (lines 3–4)

.....

 (3 marks)

GO ON TO THE NEXT PAGE



- (c) State TWO of Sula's characteristics. Support EACH response with evidence from the passage.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(4 marks)

- (d) (i) Suggest what effect Hannah's words "I love Sula. I just don't like her" (line 18) had on her daughter. Support your answer with evidence from the passage.

.....

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)

- (ii) Suggest ONE inference which can be made regarding the mother-daughter relationship. Support your answer with evidence from the passage.

.....

.....

.....

.....

(2 marks)



- (e) Explain ONE function of the writer's use of dialogue in the passage.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)

- (f) Suggest what happens next in the story. Justify your answer using evidence from the passage.

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

(3 marks)

Total 20 marks

END OF TEST

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.

The Council has made every effort to trace copyright holders. However, if any have been inadvertently overlooked, or any material has been incorrectly acknowledged, CXC will be pleased to correct this at the earliest opportunity.

01219010/JANUARY 2018



0121901017

